



that actually speaks a lot about the warped kind of thinking. And those who say sport and politics should not mix will see from this episode that it actually does, for why else was a team allowed not to start the game at the appointed hour but for the politics of keeping everything hunky dory? In no other sport would an individual or a team be allowed to delay the start of the game. It has set an unsavoury precedent for sure, and hopefully no other team is allowed to get away with this kind of bullying again.

When the second match came along, there was an improved batting performance by Pakistan in the first half before the loss of three wickets put them on the back foot again, and despite getting big runs in the final three overs, they were 20 runs shorter than what they would have wanted. India breezed to a win after a delightful opening partnership between Abhishek Sharma and Shubman Gill that took the breath away and crushed any hopes the

Crying foul: The PCB complaining about Indian players not shaking hands with their Pakistani counterparts after the game was hard to understand, as there is nothing in the rule books that says handshakes are mandatory, says the author. AFP

Pakistanis had of winning the game. In the end, another super-talented batter, Tilak Varma, treated Pakistan's premier bowler, Shaheen Shah Afridi, like a net-ball spinner and smashed him around to wrap a win with deliveries to spare.

Of course, there were no handshakes but only head shakes from the Pakistan bowlers as to how to bowl to these Indian batters who start the game in fifth gear. There are a few days left before India's next game, and it will be interesting to see what excuses the Pakistanis come up with this time for another drubbing from the country they love to hate.



What needs to be looked at is the avoiding of the mandatory media meet on the eve of the match by the Pakistani contingent. They did not have to send the captain; players or the coach, and even any among the large support staff could have met the media. That did not happen, and it will be interesting to see if any action is taken for avoiding what is mandatory.